

STARBOUND

A One-Act Play

By Christian O. Reyes

Copyright © 2026
By Christian O. Reyes

(909) 539-7585
Christiano.reyes@calbaptist.edu
8432 Magnolia Ave,
Riverside CA 92504

CHARACTER LIST

ROBERT GULF	(PHILOSOPHER)
JACK WOLFSTEIN	(BUSINESS MAN)
MALORY MILFORD	(THERAPIST)
SAMUEL THOMPSON	(DOCTOR)
SARAH POSH	(SCIENTIST)
INTERCOM	(UNKNOWN ALIEN)

Prologue

The stars are ventures into the unknown. An ocean of knowledge yet to be discovered and corrupted by the mere grasp of man.

ACT 1

Scene 1

The walls emit a faint, source-less light above each of our character's resting faces.

EVERYONE, wakes up simultaneously inside pill shaped, tubed pods onboard, in what appears to be an alien ship. They are strangers amongst themselves.

ROBERT

What is this? Where are we?!

MALORY

No, No, no. This is not happening.

SAMUEL

Easy. Everyone stay calm.

SARAH

No seams. No hinges. This looks unlike anything I've ever seen before, the walls are completely made out of tissue.

MALORY

-and they're moving. Gross!

ROBERT

No door?

SARAH

No door.

Behind them they hear someone puffin and pacing non-stop.

JACK

Hello? HELLO? Do you know who I am?!

*Proceeding to toss his body against
the gross tissue wall.*

ROBERT

I don't think they care who you are.

JACK

(Huff)

I'm SORRY- who are you?

ROBERT

ROBERT GULF, I teach near St. Petersburg actually and you?

JACK

Well Mr. Gulf... I'm sure you're familiar with my self-funded enterprise; Wolfstein Capital. Meaning, I don't know you, and I don't fucking belong here. So either get out of my face or make yourself helpful, as I have more important matters to attend to; that for one, require me there!

*Jack attempts to scuff the slime
off his coat.*

SAMUEL

(Mocking)

As in JACK WOLFSTEIN? The one caught in a scandal for sleeping with his best friend's wife before the New York campaign? I read about it in the newspaper.

JACK

Watch it buddy.

MALORY

-this is probably not a good time to be an asshole Jack... Nor for introductions, but I do think it's best we at least know who we all are. My name is DR. MALORY MILFORD, and I work in the Psychology field.

SAMUEL

My apologies for the editorial, DR. SAMUEL THOMPSON. Surgeon.

SARAH

My name is SARAH POSH (pause) I am an Astrophysicist. Which is why I can tell all of you, we are not on earth anymore and whoever built this; used an almost fabricated organic matter or ecosystem that breathes and keeps this ship alive and operating consciously on its own.

JACK

You can't possibly know that.

SARAH

Look for yourself then and tell me this is something your little "enterprise" has sold to the U.S Military.

JACK

No, but thanks for the idea.

SARAH

Doc, you able to confirm if you take a sample off of jack?

*Samuel grabs a pinch of a specimen
from his shoulder and pushes his
glasses closer to take a glance.*

SAMUEL

Blood as oil. Water, bubbles of air and small vessels of energy. All seems to check out.

ROBERT

How can you tell, that we're not on earth?

SARAH

The gravitational pull is approximately three percent off from what our bodies are calibrated to...

*Sarah removes one shoe, holds it
out and drops it.*

SARAH

The drop. It took a fraction longer than it should have.

MALORY

OH no wonder, I felt like I was having a panic attack. But makes sense, I do feel a bit lighter than I did before.

ROBERT

Hmm I just assumed it was the few pounds I lost after I quit drinking the other night.

JACK

I stink like shi-

*A sharp buzz of static feedback
silences the room.*

INTERCOM

(Overhead)

You are not on Earth. You are correct.

SAMUEL

Who said that?

INTERCOM

You were selected. One representative from each of your primary human institutions. Philosophy. Commerce. Psychology. Medicine. Science.

MALORY

Selected by whom?

INTERCOM

By us. We have observed your species for thousands of your years. We have reached a decision point of whether to intervene. Your species has for the third time developed weapons capable of ending your world within two generations. We must decide whether to stop you or allow the outcome to resolve itself.

ROBERT

SOoo, you want us to make the case for humanity?

INTERCOM

Not exactly. We want to understand what humanity sees in itself and whether You survived the first two by proximate luck. We will ask each of you one question. Answer honestly. We will know if you do not.

JACK

(Shrugging it off)

This is insane, what gives you guys the right?! You are no god of mine to call upon my day of judgment.

INTERCOM

The same right your species uses when it decides the fate of others. Generations of pretending to be God amongst yourselves. We will begin with you since it seems like you decided to volunteer first. Jack Wolfstein. You have spent your life accumulating resources. In your system, worth is measured by what one produces and consumes. By that measure is your species worth preserving?

JACK

Absolutely. Look at what we have built. Markets. Infrastructure. Supply chains that feed billions. We compete and competition drives progress.

INTERCOM

Your competition has also produced the weapons we mentioned.

JACK

Progress has costs.

INTERCOM

The cost you describe is extinction. Your very existence.

Jack doesn't respond.

Scene 2

*The Intercom continues to
question the group one by one.*

INTERCOM (CONT'D)

Samuel Thompson. You have held dying people in your hands and fought to keep them in your world. Why is a human life worth saving?

SAMUEL

Because it is sacred. Every patient I have lost, I felt it. Each person is a singular point of consciousness. There is no copy. No second variation. When they go, they go forever. That matters. That should matter to anyone.

INTERCOM

Sarah Posh. You have spent your life looking outward at us, before you knew we existed. Why?

SARAH

Because the universe is fourteen billion years old, and we have been here for a fraction of a fraction of that. And we still cannot explain most of it. Humanity is, as far as we know, the only thing in existence that looks up and asks why; That has to mean something.

INTERCOM

Have you found this... meaning, you speak so profoundly of?

SARAH

I can't say I have really thought about it till now. I guess not. All I know, as a collective union of people whatever problems we face we'll innovate past it. We always have.

INTERCOM

Malory Milford. You have spent your life listening to people in pain. What is your testimony?

MALORY

That almost everyone is trying. Even the ones who seem like they aren't. I have a patient, I won't say more than that; who has been through things I cannot describe.

(MORE)

MALORY (CONT'D)

And he still gets up. Every week, he still comes in. He still wants to be better. I don't know what you saw from wherever you were watching. But I hope you saw that. The getting back up.

INTERCOM

Robert Gulf. You have spent your life studying how humans ought to live. By your own measure, are you living as YOU ought to be?

ROBERT

No. I have spent thirty years thinking about virtue and I have been a coward in my own life. I have watched things I should have stood against and written papers about them instead. I know what the right thing is, most of the time, I just don't always do it. (pause) But isn't that the most truest thing I can tell you? We know better than we act. Some of us spend our whole lives trying to close that distance which is simply the human condition. Learning. Failing. Trying again. Then for once to finally know.

Scene 3

After some consideration, the Intercom is heard again.

INTERCOM

We have heard you.

JACK

And?! What is the verdict?

INTERCOM

We have not yet decided. But we will tell you what we observed in this room. One of you appealed to your own importance. One appealed to the sanctity of a single life. One appealed to humanity's search for meaning. One appealed to the persistence of hope. And one admitted failure without excuse. In four thousand years of watching your species, those five things are the most human things we have encountered. Not your architecture. Not your weapons. Those.

*A section of the ceiling descends
downward. Standing on it is a
figure. Human in its appearance but
it's subtle physical movements are
abnormal. It steps down into the
room and regards each of them in
turn with it's light grey eyes.*

SARAH

Oh my god.

JACK

He looks like-

ALL

-ONE OF US.

THE BEING

The neurological architecture that produces your weapons is the same architecture that produces your philosophy, grief and art. We cannot remove one without the other. We are aware of this and thus are more intrigued to see what you will do this time; to escape your eventual fate.

*It takes a step back onto the riser
then ascends.*

THE BEING

You may go.

The wall parts. A doorway opens.

CURTAIN

NOTES FOR

THEATER STAGE-PLAY:

- FIX FORMATTING
- What gives the "aliens" the right for judgment?
- Make final reveal clearer.
- Change intercom name to individual name.
- Minimize scale on a more personal level.
- How can ending be more impactful to solidify story?
- Expand initial dialogue and dynamic between characters.
- Improve on giving sidelined characters more purpose.
- Add personality and stage directions.